

Xunlong Sci-Tech (6715.HK, NC): The-Next-Gen call takeaways: Global leader in caviar driven by overseas expansion and domestic recovery

We hosted the mgmt of Xunlong Sci-Tech in our The-Next-Gen Call Series on July 16. Founded in 2003 and headquartered in Hangzhou, the company is a specialized player in the global luxury food sector listed on the HKEX. It operates a fully integrated business model spanning the entire sturgeon lifecycle, from breeding and long-cycle farming to processing, exporting, and branding. Per mgmt, caviar products contribute 90%+ of total revenue, with c.80%/20% derived from exports/the domestic market. **Xunlong is a long-standing market leader in scale/share:** Per mgmt, the company has maintained the world's largest production and processing volume since 2015, commanding a 36% global share in 2025 and nearly 4x the volume of the No.2 player. **Key takeaways:**

1) Industry growth: Mgmt shared that global caviar production volume has been growing steadily at 10~15% yoy over the past 5 years, following the transition from wild sturgeon reliance to sustainable aquaculture.

2) 2026 outlook: Mgmt guided for Rmb900mn/Rmb460mn revenue/adj. NP in 2026, both up 15% yoy. Mgmt expects GPM to remain stable at 65~70% and NPM at 45~50% in the longer term. Upside surprise came from the overseas market in 1H26 with resilient growth in the US/Europe and stronger-than-expected growth from Japan/South Korea, while domestic sales saw weakness following the anti-graft campaign in 2H25 but gradually picked up in late 2Q26.

3) Developing strategies: The proprietary *Kaluga Queen* brand now contributes c.35% of revenue, and mgmt plans to further raise the branded mix. **Overseas remains the key volume pillar (the majority of which is still OEM business),** with the company primarily selling large-format standard products to intermediaries who repackage and label them in mature Europe/US markets (c.60% of export revenue, growing at c.20% yoy annually in recent years), while working more directly with local channels to grow owned-brand sales in emerging markets such as SEA/Middle East. **The domestic Chinese market is still in an early stage,** but mgmt views it as a higher-margin brand-building opportunity, with early signs of high-end consumption recovery seen in 2Q26, and expects stabilizing domestic sales in 2H26 (lapping an easy comp base). **For the domestic development of *Kaluga Queen*,** the company is expanding B2C in two specialty store formats, i.e. large luxury boutiques in premium malls and small pop-up/concept stores as brand touchpoints, and has also launched "caviar-plus" products (i.e. caviar ice cream/chocolates) to attract younger consumers as potential core-product buyers, achieving monthly GMV of c.Rmb200k to Rmb400k+ depending on the store size. The company plans to open 50 specialty

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stores within 3 years.

4) Mgmt sees two key entry barriers/competition advantages: i) Supply constraints on biological lead time: sturgeon require 7~15 years to mature, while the company's 15k+ ton sturgeon inventory with 50%+ being mature fish, supports visible supply and a targeted 15% annual production growth over the next 3~5 years, per mgmt; **ii)** Technical efficiency: The company's egg yield (caviar to fish weight) stands at 17~18% vs. industry avg. of 10~12%, with annual survival rates at 97%+ vs. the industry's 50~70%, minimizing biological assets write-down risks.

5) Tariff risks: US tariffs on Chinese caviar peaked at 185% and currently stand at 55%, which are fully absorbed by US importers, per mgmt. The company is also actively exploring overseas farming bases to hedge against potential policy swings.

6) Cost inflation: Mgmt noted that feed costs (50% of aquaculture costs) will be amortized over a 7~15-year lifespan, but more N-T swings may come from logistics costs/forex changes (its overseas sales dominated in USD). To offset Rmb appreciation, mgmt has already discussed potential price hikes of c.10% this year with overseas clients.

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